

Boston

The best of the best in the city — must-visit, unique, a rockstar in its own right. The first edition, in Michelin's first year.

1 Michelin star — the city's first

6 Bib Gourmand restaurants

1826 Union Oyster House — America's oldest

795 places across twelve lists

Honor Roll 10

Cafés 52

Speakeasies 50

Rooftops 50

Bars 121

Coffee 50

Restaurants 168

Brunch 51

Off-beat 51

Bakeries 50

Dessert 51

Scene 50

Nightlife 51

Itineraries 1 · 3 · 5 days

Yellow = you've been ★ Michelin star **Bib** Bib Gourmand **50 Best №1** bar ranking

MR Michelin Recommended (first-year guide)

JBF 2026 James Beard semifinalist **closed** *verify = check before you go*

Resy **Tock** **OpenTable** **SevenRooms** where to book **Amex** ✓ Resy/Tock credit applies (Platinum \$100/qtr, Gold \$50 twice a year)

JBF 2026 James Beard nominee **\$-\$\$\$\$** rough spend per person: under \$20 / \$20–60 / \$60–150 / \$150+

Romantic **Date night** **Casual**

occasion (editorial, by category and price)

Compiled by Tony Abraham against Yelp, Google, The Boston Globe, Boston Magazine, OpenTable, Resy, Eater Boston and the Michelin Guide. Michelin marks reflect the 2025 Boston selection — the city's first — the most recent at time of printing. Cover: Fan Pier and the Financial District in snow, via Pexels.

Tony *Abraham*

Technology entrepreneur. New Yorker. A passionate home cook who learned that the best way to understand a dish is to try to recreate it the next morning.

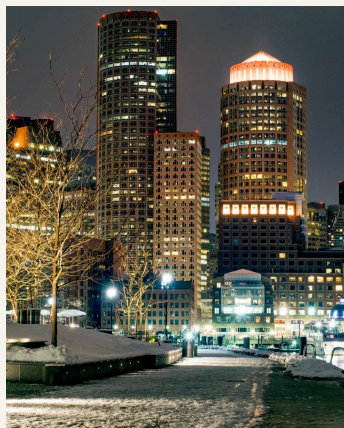
Honestly Speaking is written from a simple conviction: that the food itself — its taste, its texture, its quiet decisions — deserves a more careful kind of attention than it usually gets. The plate, not the room. The dish, not the hype.

Based in New York, with field notes from all around. *listede ville* / *Boston* is the third city guide, and the first written in a city's first Michelin year — which makes the Bib Gourmands and the "recommended" rooms the interesting part of the map.

First edition, Fall/Winter 2026. Miami, Chicago, San Francisco, Los Angeles and Seattle to follow.

Honestly Speaking is also a restaurant review site — independent, unsponsored, one dish at a time. The city guides tell you where; the reviews tell you what to order and why. Read them at honestlyspeaking.xyz.

For feedback — a question, a correction, a place we missed, or just to say hi — write to hello@listede ville.com.



Honor Roll • 10 plates

Don't leave without these.

Ten places, ranked by nothing but the plate. A cash-only slice counter, a Jiro-style ramen line, an Eastie pizza parlor from 1903 and a twenty-course omakase, all held to the same question: is this the best version of the thing in the city?

Boston now has a Michelin star, four Bibs and a wave of James Beard nominations, and most of it lives outside the North End and Back Bay. These ten are where the critics, the Guide and several thousand Google reviews all point the same way — and where the food, not the room, is the reason. Room, scene and price didn't count.

How to read it The marks are the same as everywhere else in the guide. The two lines under each name are new: why it made the roll, and what to put in front of you when you get there.

O Ya

Leather District; Tim Cushman

MR

JBF 2026 semifinalist (Outstanding Restaurant)

\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Late night Group

The tasting menu that set Boston's special-occasion standard fifteen years ago and still holds it: twenty small courses in a hushed old firehouse, luxury ingredients used with restraint rather than for show. The one splurge on this roll that earns its price.

Order The omakase, at the counter if you can get it. Take the supplements; go hungry and give it three hours.

01

Sarma

Somerville

MR \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Cassie Piuma's meze room is the hardest table in Greater Boston and the most democratic — bar seats are held for walk-ins. The menu moves constantly, but the flavors are always big, sour, herbal and sharp, and nothing on the table is an afterthought.

Order Warm gyro bread with the seven-layer hummus or avocado muhammara, the Brussels sprouts, and the sesame fried chicken if it's being passed around the room — it's off-menu and worth asking for.

02

Oleana

Cambridge

MR \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Ana Sortun's Eastern Mediterranean kitchen has been Cambridge's grande dame for two decades, and the classics are classics for a reason: layered spice, texture on texture, and a patio that makes the wait worth it.

Order Sultan's Delight (the braised-lamb-and-eggplant dish they'll never take off the menu), the fattah, the topik, and the baked Alaska to finish.

03

Jahunger

Cambridge; Uyghur

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Boston's only Uyghur restaurant and a Bib on its first Michelin outing. Cumin lamb, hand-pulled noodles and Silk Road spice at neighborhood prices, in a room that fills with Central Asian families on weekends.

Order Lamb on Dry Land (cumin lamb over torn naan) and the Jahunger noodles, at full spice. The honey cake is the reason to save room.

06

Mahaniyom

Brookline Village

Bib Michelin Exceptional Cocktails 2025 \$\$\$

Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

A Thai drinking-food bar with a short menu that lands every plate. The curries are the point — deep, tamarind-sour, properly hot — and Time Out just named it the best restaurant in Boston.

Order Beef massaman with roti, the crab curry, and the oysters with chili jam and fried shallots if they're on the chalkboard. Order the specials; the kitchen is best when it's improvising.

04

Neptune Oyster

North End

MR \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

The lobster roll every other Boston lobster roll is measured against, served hot with butter on a griddled bun in a room the size of a walk-in fridge. The line is famous; the roll is better than the line.

Order The hot buttered lobster roll, a dozen local oysters picked from the board, and the fried clams. Be there at 11am, before the door opens.

07

Bar Vlaha

Brookline; Greek

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Greek mountain cooking — the food of the Vlach shepherds, not the Athens taverna — over live fire on Beacon Street. Spit-roasted meats, hand-rolled pies and spreads that taste of the hearth. New, Michelin-recommended, and already one of the region's hardest reservations.

Order The pies (brikkis) and the potatoes to start, then whatever is turning on the spit that night — lamb, wild boar shank, trout. Sit at the bar.

05

Galleria Umberto

North End; cash, until it runs out

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

A Sicilian slice counter that opens at 10:45, sells out by early afternoon and hasn't changed in fifty years. Cash only, a paper plate, and the best cheap lunch in the city — the line is locals, not tourists.

Order Two Sicilian slices and an arancino, plus a panzarotti if you're hungry. Eat standing; it'll cost less than a coffee in Back Bay.

08

Santarpio's

East Boston; since 1903

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Group

An Eastie institution ten minutes from the airport: cracker-crisp bar pies from a 1903 oven and a charcoal grill in the corner turning out lamb and sausage. Most of the room is regulars who've been coming for forty years.

Order A cheese-and-garlic pie, well done, and the lamb tips with hot peppers and a loaf of bread. Keep the toppings light or the pie goes wet.

09

Yume Wo Katare

Porter Square; ramen, say your dream

\$\$ Walk-in

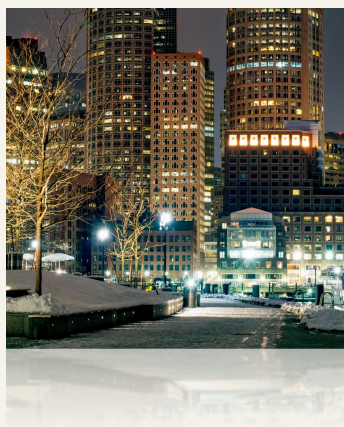
Late night

Group

One bowl, Jiro-style: a garlicky pork broth, thick chewy noodles and slabs of tender pork belly, served to a line that wraps around the block. Finish it and the staff will ask you to stand up and say your dream. Odd, sincere, and the best ramen in New England.

Order The one thing on the menu — the ramen, with the two-piece pork unless you're very hungry. Say yes to the garlic; say your dream.

10



Cafés · 52 places

Cafés & all-day / chef's neighborhood spots

Cambridge and Somerville's chef rooms, South End enotecas, and the wine bars where Boston actually eats on a Tuesday.

Boston's best everyday rooms are across the river as often as not: Pammy's, Giulia, Alden & Harlow, Sarma, Juliet. In the city, the South End's enotecas — Coppa, Toro, Bar Mezzana — and a new wave of wine bars.

Why these Picked for the room you'd return to on a weeknight. Four of Michelin's 'recommended' rooms are here (Pammy's, Oleana, Sarma, Urban Hearth), two Bibs from Karen Akunowicz's Southie pair, and the wine bars that made Boston a wine town.

Pammy's

Cambridge; the room

MR \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Alden & Harlow

Harvard Square

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Waypoint

Harvard Square; seafood + wine

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Giulia

Porter Square; pasta

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Bar Enza

Harvard Square; Italian

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Nathalie

Fenway; wine bar

new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Haley.Henry

Downtown; tinned fish + wine

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Rebel's Guild

Revere Hotel; wine bar

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Spoke Wine Bar

Davis Square

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Juliet

Union Square, Somerville; French, prix-fixe

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Sarma

Somerville; meze

MR \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Oleana

Cambridge; Ana Sortun's patio

MR \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Sofra

Watertown line; bakery-café

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual

Urban Hearth

North Cambridge

MR \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Field & Vine

Union Square, Somerville

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Celeste

Union Square; Peruvian

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Vinal Bakery & Café

Union Square

\$\$\$

Date night Casual

Highland Kitchen

Somerville

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Trina's Starlite Lounge

Inman Square

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Puritan & Co

Inman Square

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

The Table at Season to Taste

North Cambridge; prix-fixe

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Little Donkey

Central Square; Ken Oringer

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Toro

South End; tapas

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Coppa

South End; enoteca

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

The Butcher Shop

South End

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Bar Mezzana

South End; crudo

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Shore Leave

South End; tiki + izakaya

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Kava Neo-Taverna

South End; Greek

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Myers + Chang

South End

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Flour Bakery + Café

multiple; Joanne Chang

\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#)

Tatte

multiple

\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#)

Mida

South End / Fenway; Douglass Williams

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Fox & the Knife

South Boston; Karen Akunowicz

Bib \$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Bar Volpe

South Boston

Bib \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Chickadee

Seaport / Fort Point

JBF semifinalist (past) \$\$ [Resy](#)

[Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Lucca Back Bay

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Krasi

Back Bay; Greek wine bar

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Bar Lyon

Back Bay

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Select Oyster Bar

Back Bay; Michael Serpa

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Little Whale Oyster Bar

Back Bay

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Neptune Oyster

North End

MR \$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Mamma Maria

North End

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Carmelina's

North End

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Prezza

North End

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Marcelino's Boutique Bar

Boston; Providence import

new \$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Comfort Kitchen

Dorchester

JBF 2026 semifinalist \$\$ [Resy](#)

[Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Lê Madeline

Quincy; Vietnamese

JBF 2026 semifinalist \$\$ [Resy](#)

[Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Nightshade Noodle Bar

Lynn; Rachel Miller

MR \$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Faccia a Faccia

Back Bay

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

The Salty Pig

Back Bay

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Loyal Nine

East Cambridge

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Lenox Sophia

Lenox; the duck press

[JBF 2026 semifinalist](#) \$\$

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)



Speakeasies · 50 places

Speakeasies & hidden bars

Beneath a Greek wine bar, behind a wig shop, through a false library. Ranked, loosely, by the drink.

Boston's hidden bars are literal: Hecate under Krasi, Offsuit behind Troquet, the Wig Shop behind an actual wig shop, Yvonne's through a library. Drink in Fort Point has no menu and no sign.

Why these Ranked by the drink, not the door. Hecate entered North America's 50 Best in 2025; Mahaniyom's Boong Boonnak won Michelin's cocktail award. The closed ones — Hawthorne, Brick & Mortar, Deep Ellum — are listed so you know what's gone.

Hecate

Back Bay; beneath Krasi

NA50 (2025 entry) \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Offsuit

Leather District; behind Troquet

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Wink & Nod

South End; basement

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Drink

Fort Point; no menu

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

The Wig Shop

Downtown Crossing; behind the wig shop

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Yvonne's

Downtown; behind the false library door

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Bogie's Place

inside jm Curley; steaks, Downtown

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Blossom Bar

Brookline; Sichuan + cocktails

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Backbar

Union Square, Somerville; back of a hallway

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Lucky's Lounge

Fort Point; no sign

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Silvertone Bar & Grill

Downtown; basement

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Carrie Nation

Beacon Hill; the hidden speakeasy room

\$\$

Date night Late night

The Last Hurrah

Omni Parker House

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Oak Long Bar + Kitchen

Fairmont Copley Plaza

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Bristol Lounge

Four Seasons

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Marcelino's Boutique Bar

Downtown

new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Bar Pallino

South End

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Nathálie

Fenway

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Hojoko

Fenway; izakaya bar

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Shore Leave

South End; downstairs tiki

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Tiki Rock

Downtown

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Koji Club

Brighton; sake bar at the Charles River
Speedway

JBF 2026 semifinalist \$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Bar Vlaha

Brookline; Greek

new \$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Mahaniyom

Brookline Village; Michelin Exceptional
Cocktails Award 2025

Bib \$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Eastern Standard

Kenmore; reborn

new \$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Equal Measure

Kenmore; Eastern Standard's bar

new \$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Hawthorne

closed

Brick & Mortar

closed

Deep Ellum

closed

Ruka

Downtown; Nikkei + late night

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Trophy Room

South End

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Tam

Theater District; dive

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Biddy Early's

Financial District; dive

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Bukowski Tavern

Back Bay / Inman

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Sevens

Beacon Hill

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Cheers

Beacon Hill; the Bull & Finch

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Delux Café

South End

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Wally's Cafe

South End; jazz since 1947

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Lolita

Back Bay / Fort Point; the cotton-candy
exit

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Bar Boulud

Mandarin Oriental

verify \$\$\$

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Grana

The Langham; the bar

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Fed at the Langham

\$\$\$

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Six West

Cambria, South End rooftop

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Charlie's Kitchen

Harvard Square

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Grendel's Den

Harvard Square

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Plough and Stars

Cambridge; since 1969

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Brendan Behan Pub

Jamaica Plain

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Doyle's Café

closed

The Underground

Central Square; beneath the Middle East

verify \$\$\$

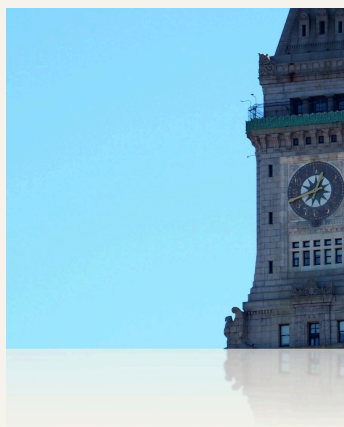
[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Rebel's Guild's back bar

Revere Hotel

\$\$\$

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)



Rooftops · 50 places

Rooftop bars

A low city with a harbor — the roofs, decks and beer gardens that catch the water.

Boston is low and wet: the views are of the harbor and the Charles, from the Envoy's Lookout, the Newbury's glass roof, and the Seaport beer gardens that open when the weather does.

Why these Chosen for the view first, and stretched to include the waterfront decks and beer gardens that do the same job in a city without many true rooftops. Seasonal ones are marked; most close by November.

Lookout Rooftop

The Envoy, Seaport

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Rooftop at Revere

Revere Hotel

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Contessa

The Newbury; the glass roof

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Colonnade Rooftop Pool

Back Bay; day passes

\$\$\$

Date night Group

Six West

Cambria, South End

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Felipe's Rooftop

Harvard Square

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Legal Harborside Roof Deck

Seaport

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Coppersmith

South Boston; roof deck

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Reelhouse

East Boston; waterfront

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Cunard Tavern

East Boston; roof

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Pier 6

Charlestown; the skyline view

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

The Landing at Long Wharf

seasonal

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Trillium Fort Point rooftop

Seaport

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Trillium Garden on the Greenway

seasonal

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Cisco Brewers Seaport

seasonal

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Harpoon Beer Hall

Seaport

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Sam Adams Downtown Taproom

Faneuil Hall

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Night Shift Owl's Nest

Esplanade; seasonal

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Lovejoy Wharf's Night Shift Brewing

North Station

\$\$\$

Date night Group

The Anchor

Charlestown Navy Yard; seasonal

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Deck at Rowes Wharf?

Rowes Wharf Sea Grille patio (Boston Harbor Hotel)

\$\$\$

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Alcove

Lovejoy Wharf

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Outlook Kitchen

The Envoy, Seaport

\$\$\$

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Stephanie's on Newbury patio

Back Bay

\$\$\$

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Sonsie patio

verify (Back Bay) \$\$\$

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Cafeteria patio

Back Bay

\$\$\$

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Woods Hill Pier 4

waterfront

\$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Row 34 patio

Seaport

\$\$\$

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Committee patio

Seaport

\$\$\$

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Lola 42 patio

Seaport

\$\$\$

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Grace by Nia

Seaport; live music

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Time Out Market Boston

Fenway; food hall

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Bleacher Bar

under the Green Monster

\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Cask 'n Flagon

Fenway

\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Loretta's Last Call

Fenway

\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Pammy's patio

Cambridge

\$\$\$

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Bow Market courtyard

Union Square

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Remnant Brewing

Bow Market

\$\$\$

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Aeronaut Brewing beer garden

Somerville

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Lamplighter Brewing

Cambridge

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Dorchester Brewing rooftop

Dorchester

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Castle Island Brewing

Southie; seasonal

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Lincoln Tavern patio

South Boston

\$\$\$

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Brewer's Fork patio

Charlestown

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Monument Restaurant & Tavern

Charlestown

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Downeast Cider House

taproom

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Envoy's Lookout

winter igloos (Seaport; seasonal) \$\$\$

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Tavern in the Square Seaport patio

\$\$\$

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Yotel's Sky Lounge

Seaport

\$\$\$

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Alcove waterfront deck

Lovejoy Wharf

\$\$\$

[Date night](#) [Group](#)



Bars · 121 places

Bars

A 50 Best entry, a Michelin cocktail award, a sake bar in a speedway, and the taverns since 1795.

A cocktail city that punches above its size — Drink and Eastern Standard trained a generation — plus the taverns that have been pouring since the Revolution.

Why these Ranked and recognized first, then institutions, hotel bars, dives, wine, beer. The Bell in Hand (1795) and Union Oyster House (1826) are on for history; the Koji Club for being the only sake bar in the Northeast; Trillium for the beer.

Ranked & recognized

Hecate

Back Bay

NA50 (2025 entry) \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Mahaniyom

Brookline Village

Bib Michelin Exceptional Cocktails 2025

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

The Koji Club

Brighton

JBF 2026 semifinalist \$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Drink

Fort Point; John Gertsen's legacy

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Romantic Date night

Marcelino's Boutique Bar

Downtown

new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Offsuit

Leather District

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Blossom Bar

Brookline

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Cocktail institutions

Yvonne's

Downtown

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Wink & Nod

South End

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

The Wig Shop

Downtown Crossing

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Backbar

Somerville

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Hojoko

Fenway

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Shore Leave

South End

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Tiki Rock

Downtown

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Nathalie

Fenway

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Bar Pallino

South End

new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Equal Measure

Kenmore

new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Eastern Standard

Kenmore

new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Ruka

Downtown

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Bogie's Place

Downtown

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Jim Curley

Downtown

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Silvertone

Downtown

\$\$

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Lucky's Lounge

Fort Point

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Trina's Starlite Lounge

Inman Square

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Highland Kitchen bar

Somerville

\$\$

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Brick & Mortar

closed

The Hawthorne

closed

Deep Ellum

closed

Bar Mezzana bar

South End

\$\$

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Toro bar

South End

\$\$

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Coppa bar

South End

\$\$

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Beehive

South End; live music

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Wally's Cafe

South End; jazz

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Late night](#)

Delux Café

South End

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Trophy Room

South End

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Bukowski Tavern

Back Bay

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Late night](#)

Citizen Public House

Fenway; whiskey

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Bar Lyon

Back Bay

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Krasi

Back Bay; Greek wine

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Sonsie

Back Bay

verify \$\$ [OpenTable](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Lolita

Back Bay

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Carrie Nation

Beacon Hill

\$\$

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

21st Amendment

Beacon Hill

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Sevens

Beacon Hill

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Cheers

Beacon Hill

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Tip Tap Room

Beacon Hill

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Alcove

Lovejoy Wharf

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Bell in Hand

Faneuil Hall; since 1795

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Late night](#)

Green Dragon

Faneuil Hall

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Union Oyster House bar

since 1826

\$\$

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Black Rose

Faneuil Hall; Irish

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Mr. Dooley's

Financial District

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Biddy Early's

Financial District

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

The Tam

Theater District

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Jacob Wirth

closed

Hotel & classic bars

Bristol Lounge

Four Seasons

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Oak Long Bar + Kitchen

Fairmont Copley

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

The Last Hurrah

Omni Parker House

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Contessa bar

The Newbury

\$\$

Date night Late night

The Street Bar

The Newbury

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Bar Boulud

Mandarin Oriental

verify \$\$

Date night Late night

Grana

The Langham

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Fed

The Langham

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Rooftop at Revere

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Lookout

The Envoy

\$\$

Date night Late night

Six West

Cambria

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Noir

Charles Hotel, Cambridge

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Regattabar

Charles Hotel; jazz

\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Late night

Scullers Jazz Club

DoubleTree, Allston

\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Late night

Liberty Hotel's Alibi

the old jail

\$\$

Date night Late night

Clink

Liberty Hotel

\$\$

Date night Late night

Precinct Kitchen + Bar

Loews

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Rowes Wharf Bar

Boston Harbor Hotel

\$\$

Date night Late night

Historic / dive / neighborhood

Charlie's Kitchen

Harvard Square

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Grendel's Den

Harvard Square

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

The Plough and Stars

Cambridge

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Phoenix Landing

Central Square

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

The Cantab Lounge

Central Square

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

The Druid

Inman Square

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Sligo Pub

Davis Square

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

The Burren

Davis Square

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Brendan Behan

Jamaica Plain

\$\$

Date night Late night

Doyle's

closed

Croke Park

South Boston; "Whitey's"

\$ Walk-in

Late night

L Street Tavern

South Boston; Good Will Hunting

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Murphy's Law

South Boston

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night

Late night

Sullivan's Tap

North Station

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night

Late night

The Harp

North Station

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night

Late night

Eire Pub

Dorchester

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night

Late night

dbar

Dorchester

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night

Late night

The Banshee

Dorchester

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night

Late night

Doyle's Café

closed

Costello's Tavern

Jamaica Plain

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night

Late night

Wine bars

Haley.Henry

Downtown

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Nathalie

Fenway

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Rebel's Guild

Back Bay

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Spoke

Davis Square

\$\$

Date night

Late night

Krasi

Back Bay

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Bar Enza

Harvard Square

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Sip Wine Bar

Financial District

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Bin 26 Enoteca

Beacon Hill

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Ward 8

North End

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Coppa

South End

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Late night

Beer

Trillium

Fort Point / Fenway / Canton

\$\$ Walk-in

Group

Casual

Harpoon Beer Hall

Seaport

\$\$ Walk-in

Group

Casual

Night Shift

Lovejoy Wharf / Everett

\$\$ Walk-in

Group

Casual

Lamplighter

Cambridge

\$\$ Walk-in

Group

Casual

Aeronaut

Somerville

\$\$ Walk-in

Group

Casual

Remnant

Bow Market

\$\$ Walk-in

Group

Casual

Dorchester Brewing

\$\$ Walk-in

Group

Casual

Castle Island Brewing

South Boston

\$\$ Walk-in

Group

Casual

Notch Brewery

Brighton; lagers

\$\$ Walk-in

Group

Casual

Bukowski Tavern

beer list

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Cambridge Brewing Company

Kendall

\$\$ Walk-in

Group

Casual

Sunset Grill & Tap

Allston; 112 taps

\$\$ Walk-in

Group

Casual

Row 34

beer + oysters

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group

Casual

Rooftop / view bars that double as great bars

Lookout Rooftop

Seaport

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Contessa

The Newbury

\$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Rooftop at Revere

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Six West

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Alcove

Lovejoy Wharf

\$ \$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)



Coffee · 50 places

Coffee shops

George Howell's town: the roasters, the North End caffès since 1929, and the bakeries that double as caffès.

George Howell invented specialty coffee here in the 1970s; Gracenote, Render and Broadsheet carry it on; the North End caffès have been pulling espresso since 1929.

Why these Selected for the cup and the room. Ogawa is Kyoto in Downtown Crossing; Diesel and 1369 are the Cambridge institutions; the original Dunkin' in Quincy is a pilgrimage, not a recommendation.

George Howell Coffee

Downtown Crossing / Newton

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Gracenote Coffee

Leather District

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Render Coffee

South End

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Thinking Cup

Downtown / Back Bay / North End

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Pavement Coffeehouse

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Ogawa Coffee

Downtown; Kyoto import

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Curio Coffee

Cambridge; waffles

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Broadsheet Coffee Roasters

Cambridge

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Barrington Coffee

Fenway / Downtown

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Jaho Coffee

South End / Downtown

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Blue Bottle

Harvard Square / Back Bay

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

1369 Coffee House

Inman / Central

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Diesel Café

Davis Square

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Simon's Coffee Shop

Porter Square

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Tatte

multiple

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Sweets Brunch

Flour

multiple

\$

Sweets Brunch

Sofra

Watertown line

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Sweets Brunch

Caffè Vittoria

North End; since 1929

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Caffé Paradiso

North End

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Polcari's Coffee

North End; since 1932

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Caffè dello Sport

North End

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Cafe Nero

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Bakey

Beacon Hill

new \$ Resy Amex ✓

Sweets Brunch

The Paris Creperie

Brookline

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Cafe Fixe

Brookline

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Kohi Coffee Company

Seaport / Provincetown

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Cafe Susu

Cambridge

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Forge Baking Company

Somerville

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

3 Little Figs

Somerville

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Bloc Café

Union Square

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Recreo Coffee

West Roxbury; Nicaraguan

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Dudley Café

Nubian Square

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Haley House Bakery Café

Roxbury

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Ula Café

Jamaica Plain

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Fazenda Coffee Roasters

Jamaica Plain

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

City Feed and Supply

Jamaica Plain

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Dwelltime

closed

Darwin's

closed

Hi-Rise Bread Company

Cambridge

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Petsi Pies

Cambridge / Somerville

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Longfellow's

Wellesley

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Mamaleh's

Kendall / Brookline; Jewish deli + coffee

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Bagelsaurus

Porter Square

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Iggy's Bread

Cambridge

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Clear Flour Bread

Brookline

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Cutty's

Brookline; sandwiches

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Dunkin'

the original, Quincy

the pilgrimage \$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Union Square Donuts

Somerville; coffee + doughnuts

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Kane's Donuts

Saugus / Financial District

\$ Walk-in

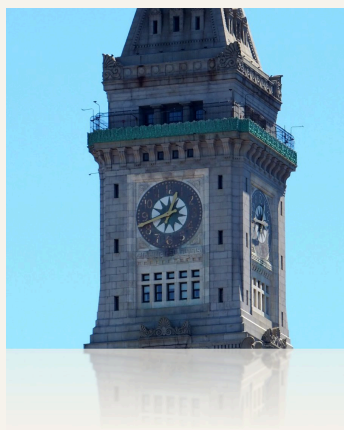
Sweets Brunch

Tatte Harvard Square

the flagship

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch



Restaurants · 168 places

Restaurants

One star, six Bibs, a long Michelin 'recommended' bench that reads like a best-of, and the seafood shacks that make the drive worth it.

Michelin's first Boston year gave one star (311 Omakase) and six Bibs, and left O Ya, Oleana, Pammy's, Neptune and Nightshade at 'recommended' — which tells you how to read this list: the Bibs and the recommended rooms are where the city is.

Why these Grouped by distinction, then by the new guard, then the classics and the seafood shacks that justify a car. James Beard left Massachusetts out of the 2026 finals; the semifinalists — O Ya, Comfort Kitchen, Lê Madeline — are marked.

Michelin ★

311 Omakase

South End; Wei Fa Chen

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Bib Gourmand (2025) & Michelin Recommended

Bar Volpe

South Boston

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Fox & the Knife

South Boston

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Pagu

Central Square; Tracy Chang

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Jahunger

Cambridge; Uyghur

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Sumiao Hunan Kitchen

Kendall Square

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Mahaniyom

Brookline Village; Thai

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Oleana

Cambridge

MR \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Sarma

Somerville

MR \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Pammy's

Cambridge

MR \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Urban Hearth

North Cambridge

MR \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Nightshade Noodle Bar

Lynn

MR \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Neptune Oyster

North End

MR \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

O Ya

Leather District; Tim Cushman

MR

JBF 2026 semifinalist (Outstanding Restaurant)

\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Uni

The Eliot; Ken Oringer

MR \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Toro

South End

MR \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Sorellina

Back Bay

MR \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Mooncusser

Back Bay; seafood tasting

MR \$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Romantic](#) [Date night](#)

Krasi

Back Bay

MR \$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#)

Comfort Kitchen

Dorchester

[JBF 2026 semifinalist](#) \$\$ [Resy](#)

[Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Lê Madeline

Quincy

[JBF 2026 semifinalist](#) \$\$ [Resy](#)

[Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Gaaeng Supper Club

pop-up; Pao Thampitak

[JBF 2026 semifinalist](#) \$\$

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

La Padrona

Back Bay; Italian

new \$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#)

Lenox Sophia

Lenox; worth the drive

[JBF 2026 semifinalist](#) \$\$

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

The new guard

Marcelino's Boutique Bar

Downtown

new \$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#)

Eastern Standard

Kenmore; reborn 2023

new \$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#)

Bar Pallino

South End

new \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Bar Vlaha

Brookline; Greek

new \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Ilona

South End; Georgian-Israeli

new \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Faccia a Faccia

Back Bay

new \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Nautilus Pier 4

closed

Woods Hill Pier 4

Seaport

\$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Romantic](#) [Date night](#)

Contessa

The Newbury; the scene

new \$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Romantic](#) [Date night](#) [Group](#)

Zurito

Beacon Hill; pintxos

new \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Ruka

Downtown; Nikkei

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Yvonne's

Downtown

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Grace by Nia

Seaport

new \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Mariel

Downtown; Cuban

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Bar Enza

Harvard Square

new \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Bakey

Beacon Hill

new \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Prima

Union Square, Somerville

new \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Field & Vine

Somerville

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Juliet

Somerville

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#)

Celeste

Somerville

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Dakzen

Davis Square; Thai

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Little Big Diner

Newton; noodles

\$\$

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Classics & must-visits

No. 9 Park

Beacon Hill; Barbara Lynch

\$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Romantic](#) [Date night](#)

Menton

closed

Sportello

Fort Point

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Mistral

South End

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Sorellina

Back Bay

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Ostra

Back Bay; seafood

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Mooo

Beacon Hill; steak

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Grill 23

Back Bay; steak

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Abe & Louie's

Back Bay

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Date night

Deuxave

Back Bay

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

L'Espalier

closed

Zuma

Four Seasons One Dalton

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Trade

Financial District

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Row 34

Fort Point / Cambridge

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Island Creek Oyster Bar

Kenmore

closed (Burlington remains)

Legal Sea Foods

multiple; Harborside

\$\$ OpenTable

Casual Date night

Union Oyster House

since 1826

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night

Neptune Oyster

North End

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Select Oyster Bar

Back Bay

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Mamma Maria

North End

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Carmelina's

North End

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Prezza

North End

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Giacomo's

North End; the line

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Regina Pizzeria

North End; since 1926

\$ Walk-in

Casual Group

Galleria Umberto

North End; Sicilian slices, cash, lunch only

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Santarpio's

East Boston; since 1903

\$ Walk-in

Casual Group

Giulia

Porter Square

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Alden & Harlow

Harvard Square

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Waypoint

Harvard Square

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Harvest

Harvard Square

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Craigie on Main

closed

Little Donkey

Central Square

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night Group

Tasting Counter

Somerville; Peter Ungár

\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Puritan & Co

Inman Square

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Highland Kitchen

Somerville

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Sofra

Watertown line

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual

Coppa

South End

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night Group

The Butcher Shop

South End

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Myers + Chang

South End

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night Group

Banyan Bar + Refuge

South End

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

SRV

South End; Venetian

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Bar Mezzana

South End

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night

Kava Neo-Taverna

South End

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Chickadee

Fort Point

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Lucca

North End / Back Bay

\$\$

Casual Date night

Bar Volpe

South Boston

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Fox & the Knife

South Boston

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night

Loco Taqueria

South Boston

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Lincoln Tavern

South Boston

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Sweet Cheeks Q

Fenway; Tiffani Faison

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Tiger Mama

closed

Fool's Errand

Fenway

verify \$\$

Casual Date night

Hojoko

Fenway

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Citizen Public House

Fenway

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Mida

South End / Fenway

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Shōjō

Chinatown

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Ruckus

Chinatown; ramen

\$\$

Casual Date night

Gene's Chinese Flatbread Cafe

Chinatown; hand-pulled noodles

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Taiwan Cafe

Chinatown

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual Date night

Peach Farm

Chinatown; late night

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual Date night

Winsor Dim Sum Cafe

Chinatown

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual Date night

Hei La Moon

Chinatown; dim sum

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual Date night

Dumpling Cafe

Chinatown

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual Date night

Pho Pasteur

Chinatown

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual Date night

Bánh Mì Ba Le

Dorchester

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual Date night

Pho Hoa

Dorchester

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual Date night

Anh Hong

Dorchester; seven courses of beef

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual Date night

Shanti

Dorchester; Indian

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual Date night

Sullivan's Castle Island

South Boston; JBF America's Classic 2025

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Yankee Lobster

Seaport

\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

James Hook & Co

Seaport; lobster rolls

\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Kelly's Roast Beef

Revere Beach; since 1951

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Belle Isle Seafood

Winthrop

\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Woodman's of Essex

Essex; the fried clam, since 1914

\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

The Clam Box

Ipswich

\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Roy Moore Lobster Co

Rockport

\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Kowloon

Saugus; the tiki palace

\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night Group

Mr. Bartley's Burger Cottage

Harvard Square

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Anna's Taqueria

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Casual

El Pelón

Fenway / Brighton

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Toro

South End

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Oleana

Cambridge

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Sarma

Somerville

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Pammy's

Cambridge

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

O Ya

Leather District

\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Uni

The Eliot

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Moocusser

Back Bay

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Nightshade Noodle Bar

Lynn

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Urban Hearth

Cambridge

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Comfort Kitchen

Dorchester

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Lê Madeline

Quincy

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Pagu

Central Square

Bib **\$** Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Jahunger

Cambridge

Bib **\$** Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Sumiao Hunan Kitchen

Kendall

Bib **\$** Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Mahaniyom

Brookline

Bib **\$** Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Dumpling House

Cambridge / Chinatown

\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Dumpling Daughter

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Yume Wo Katare

Porter Square; ramen, say your dream

\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Sapporo Ramen

Porter Square

\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Santouka

Harvard Square

\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Café Sushi

Cambridge

\$

Casual Date night

Fat Baby

South Boston; sushi

\$

Casual Date night

Ocean Prime

Seaport

\$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Romantic Date night

Mastro's

Seaport

\$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Romantic Date night

Del Frisco's

Seaport

\$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Romantic Date night

Smith & Wollensky

Atlantic Wharf

\$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Romantic Date night

Davio's

Back Bay / Seaport

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night

Atlantic Fish Co

Back Bay

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Saltie Girl

Back Bay; tinned fish

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Eventide Fenway

Portland import

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Little Whale

Back Bay

\$\$

Casual Date night

Bar Lyon

Back Bay

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Date night

Stephanie's on Newbury

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Casual Date night

Cafeteria

Newbury

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Casual Date night

Piattini

Newbury

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Lolita

Back Bay / Fort Point

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Nebo

Seaport; North End Italian moved

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Trattoria il Panino

North End

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Bricco

North End

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Antico Forno

North End

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Monica's Trattoria

North End

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Al Dente

North End

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night



Brunch · 51 places

Brunch spots

Southie brunch, the Paramount line, and the diners of Somerville.

Southie and the South End on Sunday, the Paramount line on Beacon Hill, and the Somerville diners where the cream of wheat has a cult.

Why these Kept to places that consistently top Resy and OpenTable's weekend demand, plus the neighborhood counters you walk into. Bar Volpe holds a Bib; Eastern Standard and Contessa are the new rooms.

North Street Grille

North End

\$\$

Brunch

The Paramount

Beacon Hill; the line

\$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

The Friendly Toast

Back Bay / Cambridge

\$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

Zaftigs

Brookline / Natick

\$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

Mike & Patty's

Bay Village; egg sandwiches

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Trident Booksellers & Café

Newbury

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Stephanie's on Newbury

\$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

Cafe Landwer

multiple; shakshuka

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Aquitaine

South End

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Gaslight

South End

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

The Beehive

South End; jazz brunch

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Toro brunch

South End

\$\$

Brunch

Bar Lyon brunch

Back Bay

\$\$

Brunch

Little Donkey brunch

Central Square

\$\$

Brunch

Lincoln Tavern

South Boston; the Southie brunch

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Loco Taqueria

South Boston

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Coppersmith

South Boston

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Committee

Seaport; Greek brunch

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Trina's Starlite Lounge

Inman; the tots

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Highland Kitchen

Somerville

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Loyal Nine

East Cambridge

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Sofra

Watertown line

\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Tatte

multiple

\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Flour

multiple

\$\$

Brunch

Pavement

multiple

\$\$

Brunch

Mamaleh's

Kendall / Brookline

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch

Bagelsaurus

Porter Square

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch

Kupel's Bakery

Brookline

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch

Exodus Bagels

Jamaica Plain / Roslindale

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch

Sound Bites

Somerville

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch

Ball Square Cafe

Somerville

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch

Renee's Café

Somerville

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch

Neighborhood Restaurant

Union Square; the cream of wheat

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch

Forge Baking Company

Somerville

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch

Veggie Galaxy

Central Square; vegan diner

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch

Cafe Luna

Central Square

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch

Alden & Harlow brunch

Harvard Square

\$\$

Brunch

Henrietta's Table

Charles Hotel

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

The Hourly Oyster House

Harvard Square

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Zoe's

Cambridge; diner

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Centre Street Café

Jamaica Plain

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch

Brassica Kitchen

Jamaica Plain

\$\$

Brunch

Ula Café

Jamaica Plain

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch

Bakey

Beacon Hill

new \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Cafe Vanille

Beacon Hill

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch

Eastern Standard brunch

Kenmore

new \$\$

Brunch

Sonsie brunch

Newbury

verify \$\$

Brunch

Buttermilk & Bourbon

Back Bay; New Orleans

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Bar Volpe brunch

South Boston

Bib \$\$

Brunch

Contessa brunch

The Newbury

new \$\$

Brunch

Yvonne's brunch

Downtown

\$\$

Brunch



Off-beat · 51 places

Off-beat & only-in-Boston

Fried clams in Essex, roast beef on Revere Beach, Sicilian slices for cash, and a tiki palace on Route 1.

Fried clams on the North Shore, roast beef on Revere Beach, Sicilian slices for cash until they run out, a tiki palace on Route 1, and the oldest restaurant in America.

Why these Selected for singularity. Sullivan's Castle Island won the James Beard America's Classics award in 2025; Galleria Umberto and Santarpio's are cash-only institutions; the North End cannoli rivalry is a civic duty.

Sullivan's Castle Island

South Boston; JBF America's Classic 2025

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Kelly's Roast Beef

Revere Beach

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Galleria Umberto

North End; cash, until it runs out

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Regina Pizzeria

North End original, Thacher St

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Santarpio's

East Boston

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Kowloon

Saugus; Route 1 tiki

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual

Hilltop Steakhouse

closed (the cactus lives on)

Mr. Bartley's

Harvard Square

\$

Casual

Charlie's Sandwich Shoppe

closed

Haymarket

Friday–Saturday produce market since 1830

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Boston Public Market

Haymarket

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Quincy Market

Faneuil Hall; the clam chowder in a bread bowl

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Union Oyster House

oldest restaurant in America

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Casual

The Bell in Hand

oldest tavern

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Durgin-Park

closed

James Hook & Co

Seaport

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual

Yankee Lobster

Seaport

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual

Belle Isle Seafood

Winthrop

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Woodman's of Essex

the fried clam

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual

The Clam Box

Ipswich

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual

Roy Moore

Rockport

\$

Casual

Simco's

Mattapan; hot dogs since 1935

\$ Walk-in

Casual

El Pelón

Fenway

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Gene's Chinese Flatbread

Chinatown

\$

Casual

Peach Farm

Chinatown; 2am

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual

Yume Wo Katare

Porter Square

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual

Anh Hong

Dorchester

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Bánh Mì Ba Le

Dorchester

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Pho Hoa

Dorchester

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Ali's Roti

Roxbury / Dorchester; Trinidadian

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Singh's Roti Shop

Dorchester

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Flames

Dorchester; Jamaican

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Comfort Kitchen

Dorchester

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual

Haley House Bakery Café

Roxbury

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Suya Joint

Roxbury; Nigerian

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Dudley Café

Nubian Square

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Bow Market

Union Square; the micro-mall

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Time Out Market Boston

Fenway

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Eataly Boston

Prudential

\$ Walk-in

Casual

High Street Place

Financial District; food hall

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Hub Hall

North Station; food hall

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Bleacher Bar

under the Green Monster

\$ OpenTable

Casual

Fenway Park sausage carts

Lansdowne St

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Dunkin'

Quincy; the 1950 original

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Kane's Donuts

Saugus

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Union Square Donuts

Somerville

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Mike's Pastry vs Modern Pastry

North End; pick a side

\$

Casual

Bova's Bakery

North End; 24 hours

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Toscanini's

Central Square; burnt caramel

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Christina's

Inman Square; the flavors

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Cutty's

Brookline; roast beef 1000

\$ Walk-in

Casual



Bakeries · 50 places

Bakeries

Flour's sticky bun, the North End cannoli war, and Watertown's Armenian bakeries.

Flour's sticky bun, Sofra's Turkish pastries, the North End's sfogliatelle, and the Armenian bakeries of Watertown that most visitors never find.

Why these Chosen on the strength of one signature item each. Mike's vs Modern is listed as the argument it is; Bova's is on for being open at 2am; Katz Bagel in Chelsea for inventing the pizza bagel in 1938.

Flour Bakery + Café

multiple; the sticky bun

\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Sweets Brunch

Tatte

multiple

\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Sweets Brunch

Sofra

Watertown line; Maura Kilpatrick

\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Sweets Brunch

Clear Flour Bread

Brookline

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets Brunch

Iggy's Bread

Cambridge

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets Brunch

Hi-Rise Bread Company

Cambridge

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets Brunch

Vinal Bakery

Somerville

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets Brunch

Forge Baking Company

Somerville

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets Brunch

Bakey

Beacon Hill

new \$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Sweets Brunch

Levain Bakery Boston

Back Bay / Harvard Square

new \$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets Brunch

Mike's Pastry

North End

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets Brunch

Modern Pastry

North End

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets Brunch

Bova's Bakery

North End; 24 hours

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets Brunch

Maria's Pastry Shop

North End; the sfogliatelle

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets Brunch

Parziale's Bakery

North End

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets Brunch

Lyndell's Bakery

Somerville; since 1887

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets Brunch

Danish Pastry House

Watertown / Medford

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets Brunch

Japonaise Bakery

Brookline / Cambridge

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets Brunch

Kupel's Bakery

Brookline

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Bagelsaurus

Porter Square

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Mamaleh's

Kendall

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Exodus Bagels

JP / Roslindale

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Katz Bagel Bakery

Chelsea; the pizza bagel, since 1938

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Kane's Donuts

Saugus / Financial District

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Union Square Donuts

Somerville / Fenway

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Blackbird Doughnuts

South End / multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Linda's Donuts

Belmont

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Twin Donuts

Allston; since 1955

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Demet's Donuts

Medford

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Party Favors

Brookline; cakes

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Lakon Paris Patisserie

Newton

new \$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Praliné

Belmont

verify \$

Sweets Brunch

Cafe Vanille

Beacon Hill; French

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Panificio

Beacon Hill

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Bricco Panetteria

North End; bread from the alley

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Bricco Salumeria

North End

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Cutty's

Brookline

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Bagel Guild

Somerville

new \$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Athan's Bakery

Brookline / Brighton; Greek

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Sevan Bakery

Watertown; Armenian

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Massis Bakery

Watertown; Armenian

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Arax Market

Watertown

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Central Bakery

Peabody; Portuguese

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Mariposa Bakery

Central Square

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Cafe Madeleine

South End; French

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Haley House Bakery Café

Roxbury

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Wheelhouse

Financial District; breakfast sandwiches

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Bread & Butter

Fenway; Portuguese rolls

verify \$

Sweets Brunch

Zinneken's

Harvard Square; Belgian waffles

\$ Walk-in

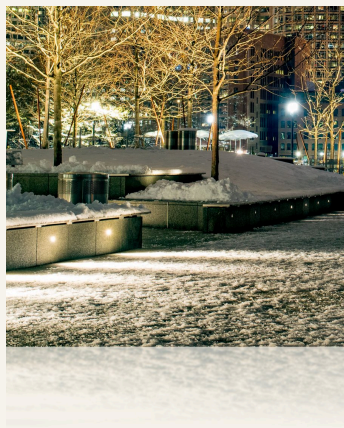
Sweets Brunch

Flour Fort Point

the original

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch



Dessert · 51 places

Dessert bars & sweets

For after — or instead of — dinner.

Toscanini's burnt caramel, Christina's flavors, L.A. Burdick's drinking chocolate, and the Boston cream pie that gives the city its official dessert.

Why these A mix of the destination and the institution. Kimball Farm and Richardson's are the drive-to ice cream stands; Taza is the chocolate factory you can tour.

Toscanini's

Central Square

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Christina's Homemade Ice Cream

Inman Square

\$

Sweets

J.P. Licks

multiple; since 1981

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Emack & Bolio's

multiple; since 1975

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

FoMu

multiple; vegan

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Gracie's Ice Cream

Union Square

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Honeycomb Creamery

Cambridge

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Picco

South End; pizza + ice cream

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Ron's Gourmet Ice Cream

Hyde Park; bowling alley

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Sullivan's soft serve

Castle Island

\$

Sweets

Kimball Farm

Westford; the drive

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Bedford Farms

Bedford

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Richardson's

Middleton

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Taiyaki NYC Boston

Chinatown

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Tous les Jours

Chinatown / Allston

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Paris Baguette

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Mike's Pastry

cannoli

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Modern Pastry

cannoli

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Bova's

the 2am cannoli

\$

Sweets

Maria's Pastry

sfogliatelle

\$

Sweets

Caffè Vittoria

tiramisu + espresso

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

L.A. Burdick Chocolate

Harvard Square; drinking chocolate

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Beacon Hill Chocolates

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Taza Chocolate

Somerville; factory tour

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

EHChocolatier

Cambridge

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Union Square Donuts

the brown butter hazelnut

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Blackbird Doughnuts

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Twin Donuts

Allston

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Levain

cookies

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Insomnia Cookies

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Bakey

Beacon Hill

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Sweets

Lakon Paris

Newton

\$

Sweets

Cafe Vanille

Beacon Hill

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Japonaise

Brookline

\$

Sweets

Tous les Jours

Chinatown

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Ho Yuen Bakery

the roast pork buns

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Great Taste Bakery

Chinatown

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Kung Fu Tea / Tsaocaa

bubble tea

\$

Sweets

Teado

Chinatown; tea

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Jaho

South End; matcha

\$

Sweets

Ogawa

Downtown; matcha

\$

Sweets

Van Leeuwen Boston

Back Bay

new \$ Walk-in

Sweets

Amorino

Newbury

verify \$

Sweets

Angelato

Beacon Hill; gelato

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Caffè dello Sport gelato

\$

Sweets

Sofra's pastries

\$

Sweets

Tatte's halva brownie

\$

Sweets

Flour's Boston cream pie

the city's dessert

\$

Sweets

Cafe Susu

Cambridge; pastries

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Lizzy's Ice Cream

Harvard Square

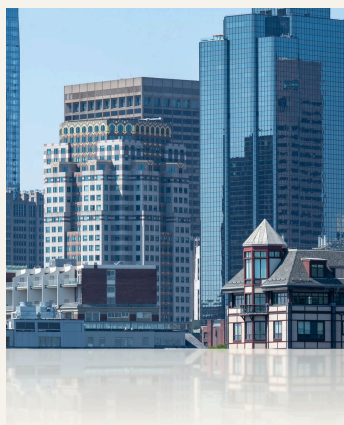
\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Sweet Bakery

\$

Sweets



Scene · 50 places

Notable mentions

Where the room is the point: the Newbury's glass roof, the Seaport steakhouses, and the hotel bars of Back Bay.

Where the room is the point: Contessa's glass roof, Yvonne's, the Seaport steakhouses, and the hotel bars of Back Bay.

Why these The hotel rooms and the Seaport lead; the old Back Bay guard stays. O Ya, Uni and 311 Omakase are here for the counter theater as much as the food.

Contessa

The Newbury

new \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Yvonne's

Downtown

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Zuma

One Dalton

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Ostra

Back Bay

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Sorellina

Back Bay

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Mistral

South End

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Grill 23

Back Bay

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Moos

Beacon Hill

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

No. 9 Park

Beacon Hill

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Bar Mezzana

South End

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Toro

South End

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Mariel

Downtown

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Ruka

Downtown

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Lolita

Back Bay / Fort Point

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Carrie Nation

Beacon Hill

\$\$\$

Group Date night

The Street Bar

The Newbury

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Bristol Lounge

Four Seasons

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Oak Long Bar

Fairmont Copley

\$\$\$

Group Date night

Grana

The Langham

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Bar Boulud

Mandarin

verify \$\$\$

Group Date night

Rooftop at Revere

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Lookout

Envoy

\$\$\$

Group Date night

Ocean Prime

Seaport

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Mastro's

Seaport

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Del Frisco's

Seaport

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Davio's

Back Bay

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Abe & Louie's

Back Bay

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Group

Atlantic Fish Co

Back Bay

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Saltie Girl

Back Bay

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Stephanie's on Newbury

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Group Date night

Sonsie

Newbury

verify \$\$\$ OpenTable

Group Date night

Eataly Boston

Prudential

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Group Date night

Time Out Market

Fenway

\$\$\$

Group Date night

Hojoko

Fenway

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Eastern Standard

Kenmore

new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Bar Enza

Harvard Square

new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Alden & Harlow

Harvard Square

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Harvest

Harvard Square

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Waypoint

Harvard Square

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Tasting Counter

Somerville

\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Group

O Ya

Leather District

\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Uni

The Eliot

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Moocusser

Back Bay

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

311 Omakase

South End

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Woods Hill Pier 4

Seaport

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Legal Harborside

Seaport; three floors

\$\$\$

Group Date night

Trade

Financial District

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Marcelino's

Downtown

new \$\$\$

Group Date night

La Padrona

Back Bay

new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

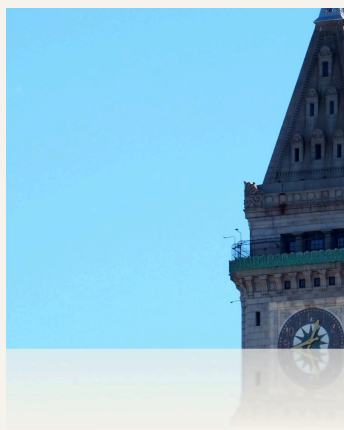
Group Date night

Faccia a Faccia

Back Bay

new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night



Nightlife · 51 places

Dance clubs & nightlife

Theater District megaclubs, Lansdowne Street, and the rock rooms of Allston and Cambridge.

Music first — Royale, the Sinclair, Paradise, Roadrunner, the jazz rooms — and the Theater District clubs after.

Why these Venues and clubs together. The Middle East, Great Scott and ONCE are listed closed because the city still mourns them; Jacques Cabaret has been doing drag since 1938.

Royale

Theater District

\$\$\$ SevenRooms

Late night Group

The Grand

Seaport

\$\$\$ SevenRooms

Late night Group

Bijou

Theater District

\$\$\$ SevenRooms

Late night Group

Icon

Theater District

\$\$\$ SevenRooms

Late night Group

Memoire

Encore Boston Harbor

\$\$\$ SevenRooms

Late night Group

Candibar

Theater District

\$\$\$ SevenRooms

Late night Group

Venu

Theater District

\$\$\$ SevenRooms

Late night Group

Big Night Live

North Station

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Roadrunner

Brighton; the venue

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

House of Blues

Fenway

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Paradise Rock Club

Allston

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Brighton Music Hall

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

The Sinclair

Harvard Square

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

The Middle East

closed (reopening?) — ?

Great Scott

closed

Lizard Lounge

Cambridge

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Wally's Cafe

South End; jazz

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

The Beehive

South End

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Regattabar

Charles Hotel

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Late night Group

Scullers

Allston

\$\$\$

Late night Group

Club Café

Back Bay

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

Jacques Cabaret

Bay Village; drag since 1938

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

The Alley Bar

Downtown

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

Cathedral Station

South End

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

Trophy Room

South End

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

dbar

Dorchester

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

Cure Lounge

Theater District

\$\$\$ SevenRooms
Late night Group

Havana Club

Central Square; salsa

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

Phoenix Landing

Central Square

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

Middlesex Lounge

Central Square

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

The Cantab

Central Square

\$\$\$
Late night Group

ZuZu

Central Square

verify \$\$\$
Late night Group

Bill's Bar

Lansdowne

verify \$\$\$
Late night Group

Loretta's Last Call

Lansdowne; country

\$\$\$ OpenTable
Late night Group

Cask 'n Flagon

Lansdowne

\$\$\$ OpenTable
Late night Group

Lansdowne Pub

\$\$\$ OpenTable
Late night Group

Game On!

Lansdowne

\$\$\$ OpenTable
Late night Group

MGM Music Hall at Fenway

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

Leader Bank Pavilion

Seaport; summer

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

ONCE Somerville

closed (pop-ups)

Bow Market's Remnant nights

\$\$\$
Late night Group

Sally O'Brien's

Somerville; live music

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

Thunder Road

closed

Toad

Porter Square; tiny

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

The Burren

Davis Square; back room

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

Atwood's Tavern

Cambridge

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

Plough and Stars

Cambridge

\$\$\$
Late night Group

Bell in Hand

Faneuil Hall; DJs upstairs

\$\$\$
Late night Group

Ned Devine's

Faneuil Hall

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

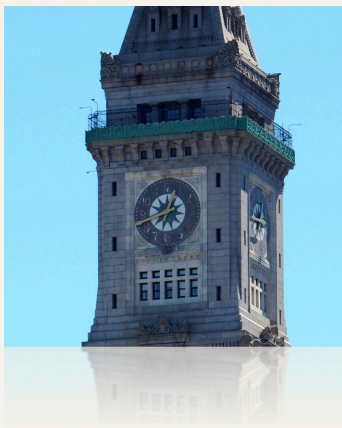
Hong Kong

Harvard Square; the scorpion bowl

\$\$\$ Walk-in
Late night Group

The Whisky Saigon

closed



Itineraries · for a first-time visitor

Just follow this.

Three ready-made food itineraries — one, three and five days — built only from places on this list, so a first-time visitor can eat well without doing the research.

Each plan runs on foot and by subway, one borough a day, with a big dinner every night and a backup for every table that's hard to get. Times are suggestions; the order matters more than the clock.

How to use it Book the starred dinners the morning reservations open, then walk everything else. The gotchas on the last page cover the rest: cash, tickets, tipping, dress codes, and the Amex credit.

Itinerary · One day

One day

North End to the South End, on foot. The day that shows why Boston argues about cannoli.

You have one day. Everything is walkable or one T stop; book one dinner. **Book one thing: dinner at Toro (Resy) or Pammy's (Resy, across the river).**

The day

8:00 **Flour (Fort Point or Back Bay)**

Joanne Chang's sticky bun and a coffee. Walk-in; the Fort Point original is the one.

9:30 **North End**

Caffè Vittoria for an espresso under the 1929 tin ceiling, then the Paul Revere House and Old North Church before the tour groups.

12:00 **Galleria Umberto (North End)**

Sicilian squares and arancini, cash only, until they sell out around one. Then the cannoli: Modern or Mike's — pick a side, take it to the waterfront.

2:00 **Neptune Oyster (North End)**

The hot buttered lobster roll at the marble bar. Walk-in only; the wait is real, put your name down and wander.

4:00 **The Wig Shop (Downtown Crossing)**

Through the wig shop. One cocktail, then walk the Common to Beacon Hill.

6:00 **Hecate (Back Bay)**

Beneath Krasi — 50 Best entry, Greek wine and cocktails. Resy.

7:30 **Toro (South End)**

Ken Oringer and Jamie Bissonnette's tapas room, still the loudest and best in the South End. Resy. Backup: Coppa two blocks over (walk-in) or Bar Mezzana (Resy).

10:00 **Wally's Cafe (South End)**

Jazz since 1947, a few dollars at the door, cash at the bar.

Three days

The city, then Cambridge and Somerville, then the Seaport and Southie. One side of the river a day.

A long weekend. Day one is the one-day plan; day two crosses the Charles; day three ends on the water. **Book three dinners the day reservations open: Toro, Pammy's, and O Ya or Fox & the Knife.**

Day 1 · The city

All day **Follow the one-day plan**
Flour, the North End, Neptune, the Wig Shop, Hecate, Toro, Wally's.

Day 2 · Cambridge & Somerville

- | | |
|-------|---|
| 9:00 | Sofra (Watertown line)
Maura Kilpatrick's Turkish pastries and a Turkish coffee. Walk-in; the morning bun sells out. |
| 11:00 | Harvard Square
Mr. Bartley's for a burger if you're hungry already; L.A. Burdick for drinking chocolate if not. |
| 1:00 | Pagu (Central Square)
Tracy Chang's Japanese-Spanish lunch — a Bib. Resy. Or Jahunger (Uyghur, Bib) if you want the surprise. |
| 3:00 | Toscanini's (Central Square)
Burnt caramel. The best ice cream in the city, and it's not close. |
| 5:00 | Bow Market (Union Square, Somerville)
Remnant Brewing in the courtyard, the shops around it. Then Backbar, through the hallway. |
| 7:30 | Pammy's (Cambridge)
The room Michelin called 'recommended' and everyone else calls the best in Cambridge. Resy, 30 days. Backup: Giulia (Resy) or Sarma (Resy, meze in Somerville). |
| 10:00 | The Sinclair or Lizard Lounge
A show, if there is one; otherwise Charlie's Kitchen upstairs for the jukebox. |

Day 3 • Seaport & Southie

9:00 **Lincoln Tavern (South Boston)**

The Southie brunch. Resy, or a wait.

11:00 **Castle Island**

Walk the loop, then Sullivan's for a hot dog and a soft serve — a James Beard America's Classic.

1:30 **James Hook & Co (Seaport)**

A lobster roll on the pier.

3:00 **Trillium Fort Point**

The rooftop, a beer, the harbor.

5:00 **Drink (Fort Point)**

No menu; tell them what you like. Walk-in; go early.

7:30 **O Ya (Leather District) or Fox & the Knife (South Boston)**

O Ya for Tim Cushman's omakase (Tock; the splurge); Fox & the Knife for Karen Akunowicz's Bib-winning pasta (Resy). Backup: Row 34 (Resy).

10:00 **Lookout Rooftop (The Envoy)**

The skyline across the channel, one last drink.

Five days

The three-day plan, plus the North Shore clam trail and one day for the counters.

Enough time to leave the city: fried clams in Essex, roast beef on Revere Beach, and the tasting counters back in town. **Set alarms for 311 Omakase (Tock), O Ya (Tock), Toro and Pammy's.**

Days 1–3

All

Follow the three-day plan

The city, Cambridge and Somerville, the Seaport and Southie.

Day 4 · The North Shore

9:00

Kane's Donuts (Saugus)

The honey dip, on the way north. Cash-friendly, walk-in.

11:00

Woodman's of Essex

Where the fried clam was invented in 1916. Whole-belly, with the tartar. Walk-in; the line is the ritual.

1:30

Rockport

Roy Moore Lobster Co on Bearskin Neck — a lobster on the back deck. Cash.

4:00

Kelly's Roast Beef (Revere Beach)

On the way back: the roast beef sandwich that started the North Shore's rivalry, eaten on the seawall.

6:00

Santarpio's (East Boston)

Pizza since 1903, lamb tips from the grill, cash only. Walk-in.

8:00

Kowloon (Saugus)

The Route 1 tiki palace. Scorpion bowls. You've earned it.

Day 5 • The counters

10:00 **The Paramount (Beacon Hill)**

The line, the pancakes. Cash-friendly, walk-in.

12:00 **Boston Public Market → Haymarket**

The market hall, then the Friday–Saturday produce market that's been shouting since 1830.

2:00 **Union Oyster House**

Oysters at the bar where Daniel Webster ate — America's oldest restaurant, 1826. Walk-in at the bar.

4:00 **Contessa (The Newbury)**

One drink under the glass roof. Resy.

6:00 **Offsuit (Leather District)**

Behind Troquet, reservation only, the quietest good bar in the city.

8:00 **311 Omakase ★ (South End)**

Boston's first Michelin star: Wei Fa Chen's counter in a rowhouse. Tock, weeks out. Alternative: Uni at the Eliot (Resy; Ken Oringer's sashimi bar) or Moencusser's seafood tasting (Resy).

11:00 **Bova's (North End)**

Open 24 hours. A cannoli for the road.

Before you go.

The things New Yorkers know and visitors learn the expensive way.

Reservations, and the walk-in bars.

Resy rooms release 30 days out at 9 or 10am; Tock counters (311 Omakase, O Ya, Tasting Counter) in blocks. Neptune, Galleria Umberto, Drink and the North End caffès don't take reservations — arrive early or accept the wait.

Cash is the North End's language.

Galleria Umberto, Santarpio's, Kelly's, Roy Moore, Wally's and most of Haymarket are cash-only or cash-first. Modern and Mike's take cards but the line moves faster with bills.

Tip 20%; tax is 7%.

Massachusetts meals tax is 6.25% plus a local 0.75% in Boston; menus exclude it. Tip 18–22% on the pre-tax total. Some restaurants add a kitchen appreciation fee — read the bill.

Last call is 2am, and the T stops before that.

Bars close at 2am (some at 1am). The T's last trains leave downtown around 12:30am — after that it's a car. Cambridge and Somerville are a short, cheap ride.

Winter is real; so is patio season.

Rooftops and beer gardens run May through October; the Envoy's Lookout does winter igloos. Fried-clam shacks on the North Shore close for the season — Woodman's stays open, the Clam Box doesn't always.

Sunday and Monday closures.

Many chef-owned rooms close one or both — Pammy's, Sarma, Juliet, Oleana all do at least one. The North End runs seven days.

The cannoli question.

Mike's is the famous one; Modern is the one locals send you to; Maria's makes the best sfogliatelle. Bova's is open at 2am. The correct answer is to try two.

Fried clams: whole-belly, or don't.

Strips are for people who don't like clams. Order whole-belly, with tartar, and expect to pay \$30+ — clam prices have doubled since 2020.

Use the Amex credit like a local.

Platinum \$100 per quarter, Gold \$50 twice a year, at any Resy or Tock venue showing the 'Resy Credit eligible' badge — no booking through Resy required.

Anything marked verify, verify.

Boston lost a run of beloved rooms — the Middle East, Great Scott, Doyle's, Craigie, Island Creek Kenmore. A minute on Resy or Google before you cross the river.

Roast beef: the three-way.

On the North Shore a 'three-way' is roast beef with barbecue sauce, mayo and American cheese on an onion roll. Kelly's is the original; Nick's and Bill & Bob's are the fights.

One for the road.

Logan's Terminal B has a Legal Sea Foods and Terminal C a Dunkin'. South Station has Pavement and, for the train, a Flour box across the street.

Notes

Michelin: the inaugural 2025 Boston selection, announced November 18, 2025 as part of the Northeast Cities guide — one star (311 Omakase, the city's first), six Bib Gourmands (Bar Volpe, Fox & the Knife, Pagu, Jahunger, Sumiao Hunan Kitchen, Mahaniyom), and a "recommended" list that includes O Ya, Oleana, Pammy's, Sarma, Urban Hearth, Neptune Oyster and Nightshade Noodle Bar. Because this is a first-year guide, the recommended rooms are marked here (MR) — they won't be in later editions. Mahaniyom's Chompon "Boong" Boonnak won the Northeast Cities Exceptional Cocktails Award.

James Beard 2026: Massachusetts had no finalists. Semifinalists — O Ya (Outstanding Restaurant), Comfort Kitchen, Lê Madeline, The Koji Club, Gaaeng Supper Club, Lenox Sophia — are marked. Sullivan's Castle Island won the 2025 America's Classics award. Hecate entered North America's 50 Best Bars in 2025; its 2026 placing wasn't confirmed for this edition.

Occasion chips for Boston are editorial assignments, by category and price. Booking platforms are listed as best known at time of printing; the Resy app is the source of truth for the Amex credit.

Photography via Pexels (royalty-free): three photographs, cropped and reused across the twelve sections.

Honestly Speaking — the masthead these guides are published under — is also an independent, unsponsored restaurant review site. The full reviews, with the plate-first criticism the city guides don't have room for, live at honestlyspeaking.xyz. The city guides live at listedeville.com.

For feedback — a question, a correction, a place we missed, or just to say hi — write to hello@listedeville.com.